

GREGG WILLIAMS

Williams Finds His Best at Palmares

Ten points better than his Boavista opener and the finest round of 33 TEG appearances, delivered on a layout he had never previously walked.

Gregg Williams arrived at Palmares having never played the course before. The previous day at Boavista he had managed 38 points. That is a score you file away rather than frame. He answered with 48, a personal best for his TEG career, built on a gross round of +14. It was the best Trophy score of the day in a field of six, and it took five points off David Mullin, whose lead in the 2017 TEG Trophy shrank from eight to five.

Two spells carried it. From the 8th to the 12th he took 18 points, including a birdie on the 4th-hardest hole on the course. Across holes 8 to 11 he did not drop a single gross shot, which at Palmares counts as a diplomatic incident. He closed with another 12 points from the final four holes. The best round of his TEG career, then. A ten-shot swing in points terms from Boavista, achieved by a man who did not know where he was going.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY Gregg WILLIAMS (48 pts)
TROPHY LEAD David MULLIN, 5 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD David MULLIN, 13 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
GW 48 AB 45 JB 45 DM 42 SN 37 JP 35
ROUND GROSS
JB +10 DM +11 GW +14 AB +23 JP +25 SN +33

AFTER R2 • TROPHY
DM 91 AB 86 GW 86 JB 82 SN 69 JP 64
AFTER R2 • GREEN JACKET
DM +15 JB +28 GW +39 AB +51 JP +56 SN +69

TROPHY

Mullin's Cushion Thins to Five

Forty-two points would win most days at TEG; on Sunday at Palmares it cost the leader three points of his advantage and left three men within nine.

David Mullin stayed on top of the TEG 10 Trophy after the second round at Palmares, with 42 points and a slightly smaller cushion. Eight became five. From the 4th to the 8th he took maximum points on every hole, fifteen in five, the golf of a man who had stopped considering alternatives. The 9th disagreed. A double bogey there, on a par 5 rated third-hardest on the card, ended the sequence without ceremony. He also held the

Green Jacket lead, trimmed from fourteen to thirteen.

The day's best individual round belonged to Alex Baker, who returned a personal-best 45 points and a personal-best gross round of +23, built on stretches of nine and ten points either side of the turn. Two career bests in one afternoon. It was not enough to trouble Mullin, which tells you something about the afternoon Mullin was having.

At the other end, John Patterson's round ended at the 1st. Not literally, but in every sense that mattered. A sextuple-bogey 10 on one of the harder holes on the course, before anyone had settled. He then played seventeen further holes, which was generous of him. The gap to the next man at the bottom of the Wooden Spoon table grew from three points to five.

STUART NEUMANN

Thirteen Shots in Three Holes

A tidy front nine ended at the 13th, and by the 15th Stuart Neumann had made two quintuple bogeys and a triple without troubling the scorecard for a point.

Stuart Neumann's second round at Palmares Praia/Alvor, his first visit to the course, was a study in contrasts. He opened calmly. Pars at the 4th and 5th, nothing dropped, no hint of what was coming. From the 9th to the 12th he gathered 14 stableford points, capped by back-to-back pars at the 11th and 12th. At that point he looked like a man in control of his own afternoon.

The back nine then fell apart. A quintuple bogey 10 at the 13th was followed immediately by another quintuple bogey, a 9 at the 14th. The 14th is the easiest hole on the course by stroke index. It offered him nothing and he took five more than that. A triple bogey 7 at the 15th completed three holes without a single net par, 13 shots gone in the time it takes to lose interest.

No recovery arrived. He closed with a sextuple bogey 10 at the 18th, one of the hardest holes on the course, and his worst hole against par anywhere in the TEG so far. The course had given him a gentle opening and a promising middle. It then took everything back, with interest, and left him to sign for it.

JON BAKER

Jon Baker Signs for Eighty-Two

Six pars in a row from the 5th carried him to the third-best gross round in TEG history, and still barely dented the Green Jacket margin.

Jon Baker shot a gross 82 in round 2 at Palmares Praia/Alvor. Ten over par, and the best gross score anywhere in the field of six that day. It stands as the third-best gross round in TEG history to date. It is also the best of his own 33 rounds, which is a long time to wait for something.

The start was orderly. A birdie at the par-5 2nd, pars either side of it, no sign of trouble. Then a double bogey at the par-5 4th, the hardest hole on the course, which ended the sequence and briefly the mood. Baker's response was six straight pars from the 5th through the 10th. The stretch also delivered 18 stableford points without a dropped gross shot.

The wider picture declined to notice. David Mullin remained clear at the top of the 2017 TEG Trophy and the Green Jacket standings. John Patterson remained anchored to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon table, where he was making himself comfortable.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 10, Round 2

TEG RECORDS
— Jon Baker's +10 (gross) is the 3rd-best Gross round in TEG history to date
PERSONAL BESTS
— Gregg Williams posts a personal-best round: 48 pts
— Gregg Williams posts a personal-best Gross round: +14
— Alex Baker posts a personal-best round: 45 pts
— Alex Baker posts a personal-best Gross round: +23
— Alex Baker — +6 Gross on the Front nine is a personal-best Front nine Gross
— Jon Baker — +1 Gross on the Front nine is a personal-best Front nine Gross
— Alex Baker — 28 Stableford on the Front nine is a personal-best Front nine Stableford
— Jon Baker — 27 Stableford on the Front nine is a personal-best Front nine Stableford

RARE FEATS
— Stuart Neumann runs up a 10 (+6) at the 18th — his career-worst on a par-4